sharing some of the most extraordinary photos that he had even sourced from India.

As information was scattered across cities and companies and so much had been done over a long time, it was difficult to get the finer details of strategies to reconstruct the vision that Ratan had. For instance, virtually no institution had mapped all the eleven components of Ratan's famous restructuring programme. The more-than-two- dozen case studies that were prepared by the world's most famous management institutes had missed the wholistic picture.

The studies typically dealt with only one or two components of his programme, when the success of each and of the aggregate depended on their complementarity and mutually reinforcing character. For instance, the famous JRD QV Award that Ratan introduced would have yielded much less if it were not tied to the Brand Equity and Business Promotion Agreement, which in turn could not be signed unless the Tata companies adopted the famous Tata Code of Conduct.

Equally difficult was the research to get to the bottom of the reasons why JRD chose Ratan as his successor, when there were many more accomplished and experienced stalwarts of the group at hand. The finding has upended the existing narrative that Ratan was chosen because he was a Tata, since at the time he was selected no one knew that he shared common ancestry with Jamsetji. This work has revealed that Ratan was chosen for a variety of reasons, the least important being that he had a Tata surname; most definitely, it was for reasons that he had a scientific mind, a distinct vision and the potential to lead the group through the tumultuous time of economic liberalization.

The entire exercise of putting together the life extraordinaire of a gentle giant who can paradoxically also exhibit the qualities of a fighter when he rarely chooses to transform into one—to only win when he does—and challenges himself always to square the circle, was exciting and trying at the same time. It melted my regret of having wriggled out of an offer from the highest office of the country to be India's representative abroad on an international body, on a prestigious assignment.

Ideally, the biography of Ratan Tata should have been at least in two volumes, as it originally was intended to be, to comprehensively capture for future generations what one determined man can accomplish in his lifetime without compromising his principles. That possibility is, however, not off